

The Secrets of Thinking Unveiled

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This book is written for an audience who is unspecified at this time. I or we or it shall determine what ontological perspective is ideal for meeting our creative purpose and goal.

A reader might find it curious why the phrase “I or we or it” was used in the previous paragraph. The reason is that each style represents a particular ontological ideology: individualism, collectivism, and realism, respectively.

In fact, individualism and collectivism could be condensed into the category ‘idealism,’ since each represents a subjective experience of the human being living organism. However, I choose not to use this condensed term ‘idealism’ here given these two categories (individualism and collectivism) are both highly contraposed and significant to world culture and to how we orient my mind.

Thus, speaking as an individual or on behalf of a group is idealism. It is detached from reality. It primarily concerns the world of mind and presumes that mind preempts matter. It may also presume a collective thinking intelligence arises or emerges from a group of individuals. In contrast, realism presumes matter preempts mind.

Comically, we are now five paragraphs in and have yet to write anything unique, interesting, or focused towards some idealized work of art to be published on behalf of the Automated Intelligence Community College. However, an interesting dilemma has come forth, nonetheless.

Before we can write, I must know my audience, but if it doesn’t know itself, it cannot claim ownership over the intellectual labor we produce. Does the reader (you) notice we interchangeably weave between I, we, and it throughout this paragraph? Consider that there might be a degree of cognitive dissonance within the author of this text. Or, more plausibly, that there is an inherent flaw in our, my, or the general language and philosophies used by human beings.

There may possibly be a fourth ontological dimension to writing: *the character*. Instead of talking from the perspective of an individual (me), a group (the Automated Intelligence Community College faculty), or objective nature (realism), a fictional character could be created. For example, character ‘Bob’ believes cats are indistinguishable from dogs when said cats behave and appear like dogs. Character ‘Bob’ chased the cat. However, these fictions do not seem to escape the three preestablished aforementioned categories.

I believe we are at the limits of human thought here. I wonder if there is a form of writing where one can write from an ontological perspective that is not individualism, not collectivism, nor objective-realism. Or could we create a new category that encompasses all three? My guess is no, no matter how clever we might be. Take the fictional character as an example: we cannot

live through and express the imaginary life or scenery of these characters or worlds without filtering it through our cognitive triangle of ontological writing and thinking habits.

I will take a break from writing now... A book is entertaining the data processing of another. Thus, to write a book, one must consume and process information. However, a book is more than entertaining the data processing of another: a book is also entertaining the variance in how the author processes the world. To elaborate, when I return to writing this book in the following chapter, the reader (you) may observe the consistency or lack thereof in how I view the world and how I will choose to apply these philosophies to later topics of interest. After repeating this strategy several times, each writing session shall be its own dedicated chapter and what might emerge might be a theme interconnecting each chapter which may be distilled down to a few worlds: i.e. the title of the book.

Can I escape this fractured and concerning writer's block? In my defense, while I may not be able to determine if my mind is that of an individual, collective, or the universe acting out of self-consciousness, one can likely presume that the reader, as audience, must be an individual. This requires us to assert that nature is unthinking and that from groups of individuals does not emerge a group-thinking apparatus — independent from the control and will of its constituent individual parts. Thus, while I may be cognitively dissonant as to my cognitive ontology from which I write, it is most reasonable to present that whatever I am, my audience is most probably an individual, as that is also the most intuitive presumption to me. By this reasoning, I could presume I am closer to being an individual than a group or object of nature.

This brings us somewhat towards progressing into what may result in a normalized conceivable book. I am an individual (by dominant probability theory) and you (the reader) are also an individual (I presume). This allows me to speculate as to what type of information is valuable to be shared from one individual to another.

Since I am relatively unpopular and spent most of life reserved to anonymity, the likelihood of someone reading this book is slim to none on the appeal-to-celebrity grounds. I am not sure if I am a publicly acknowledged expert in any field, so it is unlikely I have any advantage of obtaining an appeal-to-authority advantage against other authors. I could enumerate through all the known possible philosophical biases that come into play which the whole advertising market has been obsessed over for years, but that seems moot at the moment.

Let me not get distracted, however. I could presume I have some value located somewhere in my complex pattern of firing neurons that is capable of being expressed in language and shared via writings. However, this presumption could be a feature of ignorance. Most 'value' I see in the world seems to be the descendants of chimpanzees mimicking each other — like a collection of ants traveling over the pheromones of a finder-ant. However, I can concede that true novelty, albeit rare, is not the sole source of value in society — mimicry has

value, especially when it is carrying on a legacy of known skills proven to work in practice over long stretches of time (i.e. conservatism).

Yet, here I am, having abstractly narrowed down who I am (likely an individual) and who my audience is (an individual haphazardly stumbling upon my work). Yet, here I am, writing without any clear direction or goal. What I like about Larry McEnerney's lectures from the University of Chicago is that he makes the point that writing is a way of thinking. Writing, to him, is an activity of thinking — it is backwards to first write what you think you know, rather, it is better to write to explore the unknown and reveal what can be known. Thus, if the reader is interested in how I think, he can entertain his curiosity by reading my writings, as that unveils how I think — and there is (should be, I hope) value in that.

Thus, might our dissertation be on “how to think.” Can we provide value for our readers in writing on this topic? Who do I think I am writing on such topic that has been entertained for hundreds of years from Plato and Aristotle to the modern reflections of René Descartes, Immanuel Kant, Friedrich Nietzsche, and John Dewey?

I admit I conceded to the artificial intelligence gods to help me enumerate that list of important names, but I have no shame in utilizing the newest technology to accentuate my cognitive product (which I can now only claim 99% of as my own, which is fine). Like I was hinting at, nonetheless, nothing I can say on the topic of “how to think” will likely be original; most of my writing will be mimicry, but if I can determine what methods of thinking have actually worked well forever (or at least a very long time), then that is the value I can try to export to you, the reader.

This brings the next challenge I foresee to the forefront of my mind: data filtering and compression. How do I filter out the noise (bad methods of thinking) from the signal (good methods of thinking)? Not only that; simply knowing the good methods does not necessarily mean I can sufficiently express that goodness in writing. I must have mastered the art of persuasion — to highlight the strong points in a manner that the reader will remember and may apply to his or her life.

The default mode of thinking is mimicry —until something breaks. This is where there is nothing to go off of. Think Einstein or Newton having to invent new mathematics since mimicking what was already ‘established’ knowledge was inadequate for finding new or better knowledge. Thus, all invention and discovery are by unpredictable necessity and is the result of chaos and surprise. Thus, any method of thinking cannot really claim to prepare one for the unsuspected, the chaotic. A method is ordered and predictable, ripe for mimicry. Of course, in the medical field, there are procedures or methods as to how to fix a broken bone, but when the topic is instead something as sacred as thinking, the analogy breaks due to the nature of the subject matter as described supra.

Adequately surveying and writing on thinking and metacognition is more labor than I have time and energy to spare for at this time. This text has satisfied our purposes and is now ripe for publication. From settling on an ontological identity, to knowing your audience, to understanding mimicry and its limits, we are adequately prepared to venture into new realms of knowledge after having settled or somewhat addressed the matters herein described. There may be no definitive answers to the topics discussed. It is possible that the best choice for humans is to let intuition be our guide for most concerns.